

Stem Collection Field Instructions

When recording a new stem (recruit)...

Assign it a new tag ID if it is a new organism.

Record the *X* and *Y* coordinates, *species*, *POM*, *DBH*, and *status* on a blank stem sheet.

If it is a previously unrecorded species, please add how you identified the species of the stem into the *Notes* column.

Either local or scientific names are acceptable.

If you cannot identify the species of a new stem...

Take a sample of the leaves, fruit, seeds, or flowers and indicate a sample was taken in *Voucher Taken*.

If a stem has no tag...

Check the ground to see if the tag has fallen off. Use the location of the stem against the data sheets to determine if it has already been recorded in another census. If no tag or record can be found, record it as a recruit.

If a POM of 1.3m is not viable due to damage....

Record the new POM in the *POM* column and the associated DBH in the *DBH* column.

Record the DBH at 1.3m in the *Notes* column with reason why a POM 1.3m is not viable (e.g. wound, swelling, bark loss, or branch).

If the stem is wounded...

Put a check in the *Wounded* column. Then in the *Notes* column, record the percentage of cambium exposed (i.e. bark missing). This should be estimated on 4 sides of the stem, from the ground to 2 m height. Also, record the presence / absence of bracket fungus in the *Notes* column.

If a new stem is sprouting from a tree that is already tagged....

Give the stem a new tag, check for an existing tag on that organism, and record the existing tag ID in *base ID* (aka tree ID).

If a stem is dead...

And the rest of the tree is dead, mark the stem as dead (**D**) in the *Status* column, otherwise, if there is life elsewhere on the tree, mark the stem as resprouting (**R**)

If dead (**D**), record the *Mode*, *Cause of Damage*, presence / absence of *Bracket Fungus* and the percentage of *Cambium* exposed.

If a stem is missing...

Do your best to locate the stem using the information on the data sheets.

If the stem cannot be located, record it as either vanished (**V**) or presumed dead (**X**) in *Mode*.

Status	Mode	Cause of Damage
A = Alive	B = Broken/cut (stem detached)	A = Animals (not elephants)
R = stem dead, but signs of life elsewhere (base or other stems)	C = Climbers/stranglers in canopy	E = Elephant
D = Stem and base dead	F = Fallen (not supporting itself)	F = Fire
	G = Hollow	H = Human (cut or ringbarked)
	J = Bark peeling or lost	I = Frost
	K = Bracket fungi	L = Lightning
	L = Leaning (>15° from vertical)	M = Termites
	M = On termite mound	N = Neighbouring tree
	N = New recruit	O = Other (describe in notes)
	P = Snapped (still attached)	Q = Unknown
	Q = Location unknown, not found	W = Wind
	S = Standing	
	T = Stump	
	U = Uprooted	
	V = Location known , vanished	
	W = Stem is a liana	
	Y = Wounded	
	Z = Sick or rotten wood	
	O = Other	